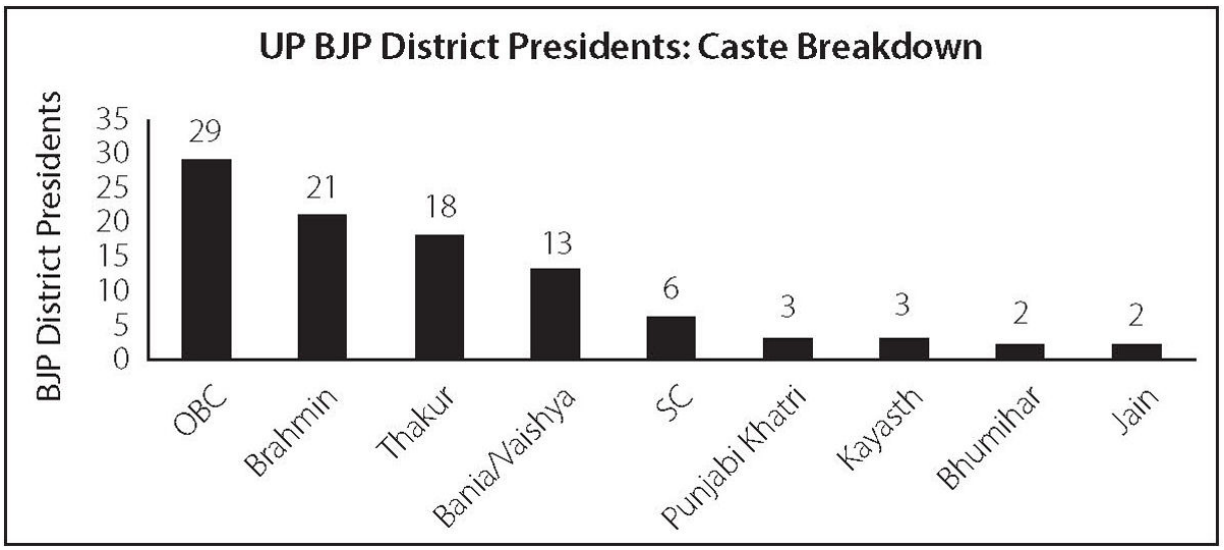


Source: Fieldwork and analysis by the Mehta–Singh Social Index. Data analysed from the UP BJP district presidents' list, accurate as of 25 July 2020.

Booth Committees, Reorganised Party Structure and Caste Balancing

K.P. Maurya, the OBC leader who led the party as state unit chief in the UP campaign of 2017, says that the reorganisation of the state into regions and the creation of a booth-level structure was fundamental to the party's strategy. 'We held six booth-level sammelans, one in each region, where our national president came [in 2016-17]. This sent a very big message. We repeated this process at the district level, then at the Vidhan Sabha level and then at the Lok Sabha level. In terms of organisation, we have created such a strong structure that BJP on this basis has created such a factory that it can produce as many MPs and MLAs as you want for the nation's service.'[50]

Significantly, the party was very mindful of caste in these local structures as well. Of UP's 1,47,164 voting booths, it set up booth presidents and fifteen-member booth-level committees in 1,20,000 booths during Rajnath Singh's tenure and while Amit Shah headed UP affairs. 'They left out some booths that were in Muslim-dominated areas like in Rampur or Moradabad,' says Pravin Kumar, the biographer of Yogi Adityanath and resident editor of a big daily in Lucknow. 'Amit Shah ensured equal representation at the booth level